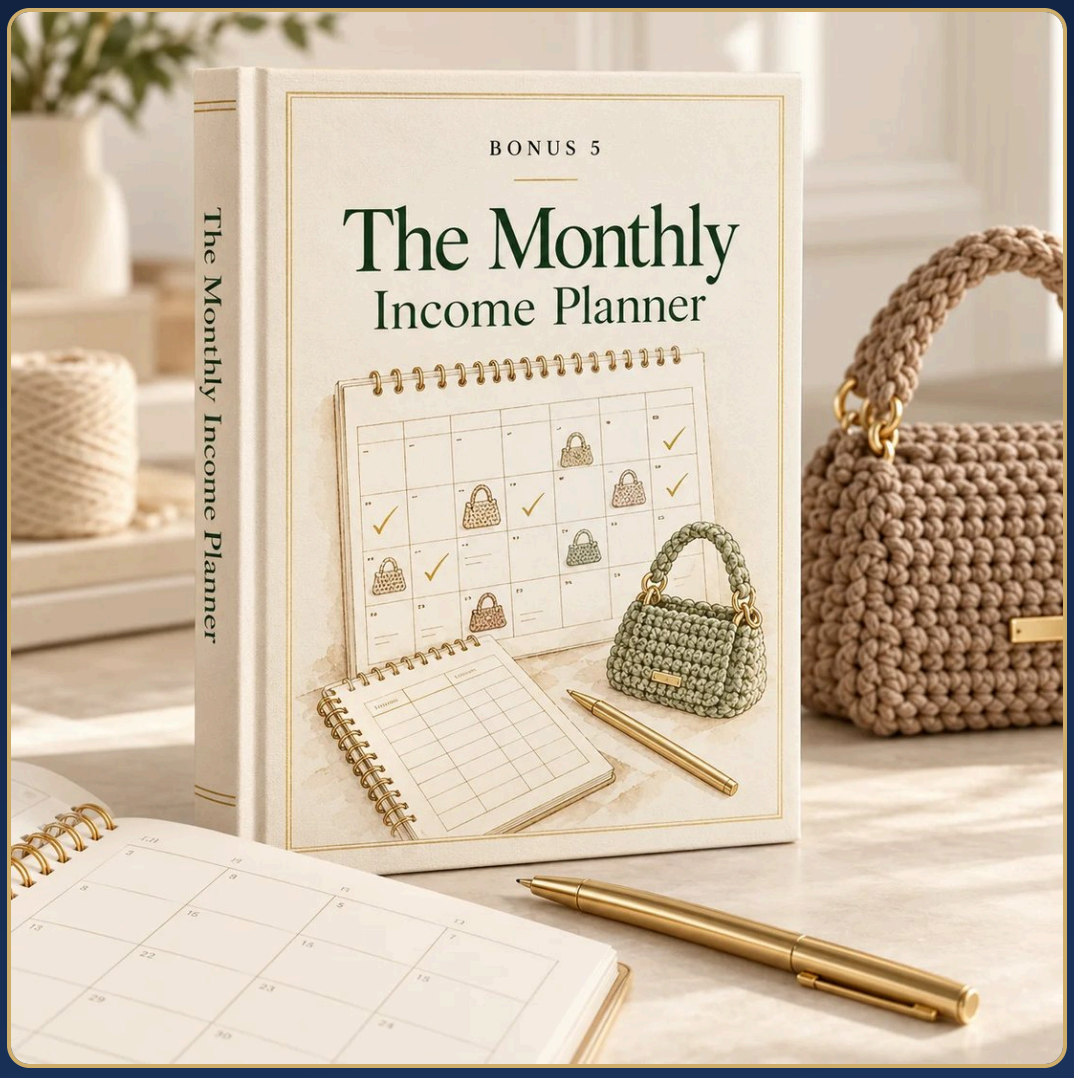
BONUS 5 OF 5

The Monthly Income Planner

A week-by-week plan with a clear target



In this guide

Start Here: What This Planner Is (and Is Not)

The Math in One Line

Your Three Plans

Make the Money Work: The Reinvest Rule

Your Monthly Tracker

If You Sell Less Than Planned

Organize Your Week in Short Sessions

Be Honest About What Affects Your Results

Your Monthly Checklist

Putting It Together: A Quick Example

Next step

> *You do not need a big dream and a vague hope. You need a number. This planner turns "I would love to earn something from my bags" into a simple weekly target you can actually follow.*

Start Here: What This Planner Is (and Is Not)

This guide shows you the math behind selling handmade bags. It answers one question: how many bags do you need to make and sell each week to reach $500, $1,000 or $2,000 in a month?

Every number in these pages is an example. Your prices, costs, free time and local market will be different. Use the examples to build your own plan, then adjust as you learn what works for you.

> **Educational guide, not a promise**
>
> This planner is an educational guide. It does not guarantee any income, and it is not tax, legal or financial advice. The $500, $1,000 and $2,000 plans are scenarios, not predictions. Earning up to $2,000 a month takes time, customers and steady sales, and many people will earn less. Check the tax and business rules where you live before you start selling.

The Math in One Line

Here is the whole idea. It fits on a sticky note:

> **The formula**
>
> **Bags per month = Monthly goal ÷ Profit per bag**

Profit per bag is what is left after you pay for materials. If you sell a bag for $75 and the materials cost you $10, your profit is $65.

Step 1: Find your profit per bag

Take the example price from The $75 Pricing Formula: $75 per bag. Now subtract your materials. Small bags with simple hardware can cost around $5 to make. Larger bags with nicer chains and clasps can cost around $8 to $12. Prices vary by store and by the season, so use your own receipts.

ITEM	LOW-COST BAG	HIGHER-COST BAG
Selling price	$75	$75
Materials (canvas, yarn, hardware, lining)	$8	$12

ITEM	LOW-COST BAG	HIGHER-COST BAG
Profit per bag	$67	$63

To keep the math easy, the rest of this guide uses a middle number: **$10 in materials and $65 in profit per bag**.

Step 2: Divide your goal by your profit

MONTHLY GOAL	THE MATH	BAGS PER MONTH	BAGS PER WEEK
$500	$500 ÷ $65 = 7.7	About 8	About 2
$1,000	$1,000 ÷ $65 = 15.4	About 16	About 4
$2,000	$2,000 ÷ $65 = 30.8	About 31	About 7 to 8

Always round up. If the math says 7.7 bags, plan for 8. That small buffer helps if a sale falls through.

> **Read this twice**
>
> These numbers assume every bag sells at the full $75 list price. In real life, some bags sell slowly, some sell at a discount, and some are gifts for friends. That is why the next sections include a plan for selling less than expected.

Step 3: Count your time too

Money is only half of the picture. A bag takes time, and your time has value. Plan on around 3 to 4 hours per bag, including cutting the canvas, stitching, assembling and photographing it. Small bags may go faster. Large bags with detailed patterns may take longer.

MONTHLY GOAL	BAGS	HOURS OF MAKING	HOURS PER WEEK (MAKING)
$500	8	24 to 32 hours	6 to 8 hours
$1,000	16	48 to 64 hours	12 to 16 hours
$2,000	31	93 to 124 hours	23 to 31 hours

Add time for messages, photos and packing. Selling takes time too, usually an extra hour or two per week at the lower goals, and more at the higher ones.

Now divide the goal by the hours. At the $500 goal, you would earn roughly $500 for 30 hours of work, which is around $16 an hour before any selling time. That is a useful number to know before you decide how much of your week to give to this.

Your Three Plans

Pick the plan that fits your real life, not the one that sounds most exciting. You can always move up later. Each plan has four weeks. The tables show how many bags to make, how many hours to plan, how many sales messages to send, and how many sales to aim for.

The messages column uses a simple assumption: about 1 sale for every 10 conversations. Your own rate may be better or worse. Track it in the tracker below and replace my guess with your real number.

Plan A: The $500 Month (about 8 bags)

A gentle start. It suits you if you have a few free hours a week and want to test whether selling is for you.

WEEK	BAGS TO MAKE	HOURS (MAKING)	SALES MESSAGES TO SEND	SALES TARGET	PROFIT TARGET
Week 1	2	6 to 8	20	2	$130
Week 2	2	6 to 8	20	2	$130
Week 3	2	6 to 8	20	2	$130
Week 4	2	6 to 8	20	2	$130
Month	**8**	**24 to 32**	**80**	**8**	**$520**

Eight sales at $65 profit is $520, a little above the goal. That small cushion is intentional.

Plan B: The $1,000 Month (about 16 bags)

A steady side project. It suits you if you can give about two hours most days and you are comfortable talking to customers.

WEEK	BAGS TO MAKE	HOURS (MAKING)	SALES MESSAGES TO SEND	SALES TARGET	PROFIT TARGET
Week 1	4	12 to 16	40	4	$260

WEEK	BAGS TO MAKE	HOURS (MAKING)	SALES MESSAGES TO SEND	SALES TARGET	PROFIT TARGET
Week 2	4	12 to 16	40	4	$260
Week 3	4	12 to 16	40	4	$260
Week 4	4	12 to 16	40	4	$260
Month	**16**	**48 to 64**	**160**	**16**	**$1,040**

Plan C: The $2,000 Month (about 31 bags)

A serious part-time business. This is the "up to $2,000 a month" scenario, and it is the hardest of the three. It needs a lot of hours, a steady stream of customers and consistent sales. Many people will not reach it, and that is perfectly normal.

WEEK	BAGS TO MAKE	HOURS (MAKING)	SALES MESSAGES TO SEND	SALES TARGET	PROFIT TARGET
Week 1	8	24 to 32	80	8	$520
Week 2	8	24 to 32	80	8	$520
Week 3	8	24 to 32	80	8	$520
Week 4	7	21 to 28	70	7	$455
Month	**31**	**93 to 124**	**310**	**31**	**$2,015**

> **An honest note about Plan C**
>
> Making 8 bags a week means roughly 3 to 4 hours of stitching every single day, plus selling time. Start with Plan A or B, build your customer list, and only move up when the lower plan feels easy. Growing step by step is a strength, not a weakness.

Make the Money Work: The Reinvest Rule

Here is a simple rule that keeps your little business from costing you extra: **every sale pays for the materials of your next bags.**

At the start, you buy materials with your own money. After your first sale, set aside the cost of the next materials before you spend anything else.

1. Sell a bag for $75.
2. Move $10 into your "materials" envelope or jar.
3. Use that $10 to buy supplies for the next bag.
4. The remaining $65 is your profit.

Do this every time. After the first one or two sales, your business runs on its own money and you are no longer paying out of pocket.

> **A small habit that helps**
> Keep your materials money in a separate envelope or a separate account. When it is mixed with your grocery money, it is very hard to know whether you are really making a profit.

Think about stock, not just single bags

Buying yarn and canvas in bigger packs often lowers the cost per bag. Once you have a few sales, you can reinvest a little more and buy in bulk. Do this slowly, and only with money your sales have already paid you.

Your Monthly Tracker

What you track, you can improve. Write down every bag you make. Print this page or copy the table into a notebook. Add as many rows as you need.

DATE	BAG	MATERIALS COST	TIME (HOURS)	SALE PRICE	PROFIT
		$		$	$
		$		$	$
		$		$	$
		$		$	$
		$		$	$

DATE	BAG	MATERIALS COST	TIME (HOURS)	SALE PRICE	PROFIT
		$		$	$
		$		$	$
		$		$	$
		$		$	$
		$		$	$

At the end of the month, add up the last column. That is your real profit. Then divide it by your total hours to see what you earned per hour.

Month at a glance

QUESTION	YOUR ANSWER
Bags made this month	
Bags sold this month	
Total sales ($)	
Total materials ($)	
Total profit ($)	
Total hours worked	
Profit per hour ($)	
Messages sent / sales made	

If You Sell Less Than Planned

It will happen at some point, and it does not mean you are failing. Every seller has slow weeks. The point of a plan is that you can see exactly what is happening and respond calmly.

Look at your tracker and ask three questions

1. **Am I making enough bags?** If your shelf is empty, you have nothing to sell. Return to your weekly making target.

2. **Am I showing them to enough people?** If you sent fewer messages than planned, that is your answer. Send the full number for two weeks.
3. **Am I asking a fair price?** If people love the bag but never buy, test a small change, like a limited-time offer. Do not drop your price below what covers your materials and your time.

Simple ways to adjust

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO TRY
You made the bags but sold few	Send more messages, post more photos, ask past buyers for a referral
You sold well but ran out of bags	Add one extra making session per week
Bags take much longer than 4 hours	Choose simpler patterns for a while and keep the detailed ones for special orders
Sales are slow in some months	Plan ahead for seasons and make seasonal bags before they are needed
You are tired or behind	Drop one plan level for a month. A smaller steady plan beats a big plan you abandon

If you sell only half of what Plan B expects, you still have a result: about 8 sales and roughly $520 in profit. That is Plan A. Plans overlap, so you never really "miss" them. You just land on a different step.

Organize Your Week in Short Sessions

You do not need a free weekend to do this. Short, regular sessions work well. Thirty minutes a day is a real start, and it adds up to 3.5 hours a week.

A sample week for Plan A (about 7 hours)

DAY	SESSION	FOCUS
Monday	45 min	Stitch the front panel
Tuesday	30 min	Stitch the back panel
Wednesday	30 min	Send 10 sales messages
Thursday	60 min	Assemble and add hardware
Friday	30 min	Photos and a new post

DAY	SESSION	FOCUS
Saturday	90 min	Make bag number two
Sunday	30 min	Update the tracker, plan next week

Some people prefer one long afternoon. Others do better with a little each evening. Try both for two weeks and keep the one that fits your life.

Tips for keeping the rhythm

- Keep a project bag ready by your chair, so you can start in seconds.
- Pair stitching with something you already do, like a favorite show or a podcast.
- Use the same time every day. Habits form faster that way.
- Do the selling tasks when your energy is highest. Do the easy stitching when you are tired.
- Count holes in small groups, take breaks, and rest your hands and eyes.

Be Honest About What Affects Your Results

Numbers on a page are tidy. Real life is not. Here are the main things that change your results, and none of them are in your control entirely.

- **Time.** Life gets busy. Children, work and family come first, and that is as it should be.
- **Your local market.** Some towns love handmade bags and some do not. Selling online widens your reach, but it also adds more competition.
- **Seasons.** Holidays, spring, and back-to-school are often busier than quiet months. Plan for ups and downs.
- **Your skill and speed.** You get faster with each bag. Your first bag may take twice as long as your tenth.
- **Your customers.** It takes time to find people who love what you make. Early months are usually slower.
- **Costs you forgot.** Packaging, shipping, platform fees and card fees can reduce your profit. Add them to your tracker once you know them.

> **Taxes and local rules**
>
> Selling handmade goods may involve taxes, licenses or permits, depending on where you live. Rules differ by country, state and city. This guide is not tax or legal advice. Please check your local requirements, or ask a qualified professional, before you start selling.

Your Monthly Checklist

BEFORE THE MONTH BEGINS

- [ ] Choose your plan: $500, $1,000 or $2,000
- [ ] Write down your price and your materials cost
- [ ] Set up your materials envelope
- [ ] Plan your weekly making sessions on the calendar
- [ ] List 20 people or groups you can show your bags to
- [ ] Print your tracker page

EVERY WEEK

- [ ] Make the bags on your weekly target
- [ ] Send the sales messages on your weekly target
- [ ] Post at least two clear photos
- [ ] Record each sale in the tracker
- [ ] Move materials money into the envelope
- [ ] Review: did I reach my weekly target?

END OF THE MONTH

- [ ] Add up sales, costs and profit
- [ ] Divide profit by hours worked
- [ ] Count messages sent and sales made
- [ ] Write down what worked and what did not
- [ ] Decide: stay on this plan, go down a level, or move up
- [ ] Set aside money for taxes if your local rules require it

Putting It Together: A Quick Example

Let us say Maya wants about $500 this month. She sells her bags at $75 and her materials cost about $10. Her profit is $65 per bag.

$500 ÷ $65 is 7.7, so she plans on 8 bags, or 2 a week. She works 30 to 60 minutes most evenings, and she sends about 20 messages a week.

In week one she sells one bag and a friend asks for a second. She sets aside $10 for the next materials. In week two she sells two. By week four she has sold 6 bags and has 2 more on the shelf. That is about $390 in profit, and two more bags waiting for owners.

She is under her goal, but she is not lost. She knows what to do: keep her messages up, show the two ready bags to more people, and try again next month. This is how the plan helps you. You always see where you stand.

Maya is an example, not a real customer, and her results are not a promise. Your results will be your own.

Next step

Choose one plan and write your number at the top of a page: your goal, your price, your materials cost and your bags per week. Then book your first three making sessions in your calendar this week. Start small, track every bag, and let your own numbers guide the next month.